Ford Motor Company

James P. Vondale, Director
Automotive Safety Office
Environmental & Safety Engineering

April 18, 2002

Mr. Kenneth N. Weinstein
Associate Administrator for Safety Assurance
National Highway Traffic Safety Administration
400 Seventh Street, S.W.
Washington, D.C. 20590

Re: Ford Recall No. 02S37 – 2002 Model Year Focus SVT – Speed Control Cable Interference

Dear Mr. Weinstein:

Summary

- Ford Action -- Ford is conducting a voluntary safety recall involving 2002 Model Year Focus SVT vehicles, built from November 6, 2001 through April 8, 2002, with the potential for interference between the speed control cable end and the throttle body bracket.

- Number of Vehicles Involved – Approximately 569 vehicles (534 in the United States and Federalized Territories, 12 in Canada, 9 in Mexico and 14 in other countries.)

- Affect on Vehicle Operation – In some of the affected vehicles, there is the potential for the end of the speed control cable to interfere with the tabs of the throttle body bracket during a wide-open throttle application, which may potentially prevent the throttle from returning to the closed position when the accelerator is released.

- Service Procedure -- Dealers will be instructed to stop demonstrating vehicles until the speed control cable has been disconnected prior to the availability of a redesigned throttle body assembly. Dealers will be instructed to stop delivering vehicles until, at the discretion of the customer, either the speed control cable has been disconnected or until the throttle body assembly has been replaced with a redesigned throttle body assembly. When redesigned throttle body assemblies become available, dealers will be instructed to replace the throttle body assembly with the redesigned throttle body assembly and reconnect the speed control cable.

Attached is the detailed information required by the applicable portions of 49 CFR Part 573 -- Defect and Non-Compliance Information Report.

Sincerely,

James P. Vondale

Attachment
02S37 5d/pcw/tb

ATTACHMENT

49 CFR Part 573 -- DEFECT INFORMATION REPORT
02S37 – 2002 MODEL YEAR FORD FOCUS SVT

Pursuant to Part 573 of Title 49 of the Code of Federal Regulations, Defect and Noncompliance Reports, Ford Motor Company submits the following information concerning a safety recall action that it is voluntarily initiating.

573.5 (c) (2) -- Potentially Affected Vehicles

All 2002 Model Year Ford Focus SVT vehicles built from November 6, 2001 through April 8, 2002 at the Hermosillo Assembly Plant are potentially affected.

Because these vehicles are not produced in VIN order, information as to the applicability of this action to specific vehicles can best be obtained by either calling Ford's toll-free line (1-800-392-3673) or contacting a local Ford dealer, who can obtain specific information regarding the vehicles from the Ford On-line Automotive Service Information System (OASIS) database.

573.5 (c) (3) -- Estimated Population of Vehicles Potentially Affected

Approximately 534 Focus SVT vehicles in the United States and Federalized Territories.

573.5 (c) (4) -- Estimated Percentage of Affected Vehicles with the Defect Condition

All of the involved vehicles have the potential for the speed control cable to interfere with the throttle body bracket.

573.5 (c) (5) -- Description of the Defect

The 2002 Focus SVT vehicles, all of which are equipped with manual transmission, utilize a unique throttle body and accelerator cable from that used in the base Focus with Zetec engine and manual transmission. The speed control cable is common with the base Focus with Zetec and manual transmission. Due to a difference in positioning of this unique Focus SVT throttle body, the end of the speed control cable has the potential to interfere with the tabs of the throttle body bracket during a wide-open throttle application. This interference condition may potentially prevent the throttle from returning to the closed, or idle, position when the accelerator is released. If this condition were to occur, the vehicle could be brought to a stop by engaging the clutch pedal and applying the brakes.

There have been no occurrences of the condition reported by vehicle owners and there are no reported accidents or injuries attributed to this condition.

573.5 (c) (6) -- Chronology of Events

On April 5, 2002, during a drive evaluation by Ford personnel at Hermosillo Assembly Plant, a vehicle exhibited a stuck accelerator pedal concern during a wide-open throttle application. It was determined that the condition was due to interference between the speed control cable end and the tabs on the throttle body bracket, which prevented the throttle from returning to the closed, or idle, position when the accelerator was released. Disengagement of the clutch and brake application brought the vehicle to a safe stop.

573.5 (c) (8) -- Service Program

Dealers will be instructed to stop demonstrating vehicles until the speed control cable has been disconnected prior to the availability of a redesigned throttle body assembly. Dealers will be instructed to stop delivering vehicles until, at the discretion of the customer, either the speed control cable has been disconnected or until the throttle body assembly has been replaced with a redesigned throttle body assembly. When redesigned throttle body assemblies become available, dealers will be instructed to replace the throttle body assembly with the redesigned throttle body assembly and reconnect the speed control cable.

There will be no charge to owners for this service.

573.5 (c) (9) -- Press statement and Dealer/Owner Letters

Ford does not plan to make a public statement concerning the subject matter of this action. A copy of the Notification letters to dealers and owners from Ford will be forwarded when available.

573.5 (c) (11) -- Recall Number

Ford has assigned recall number 02S37 to this action.